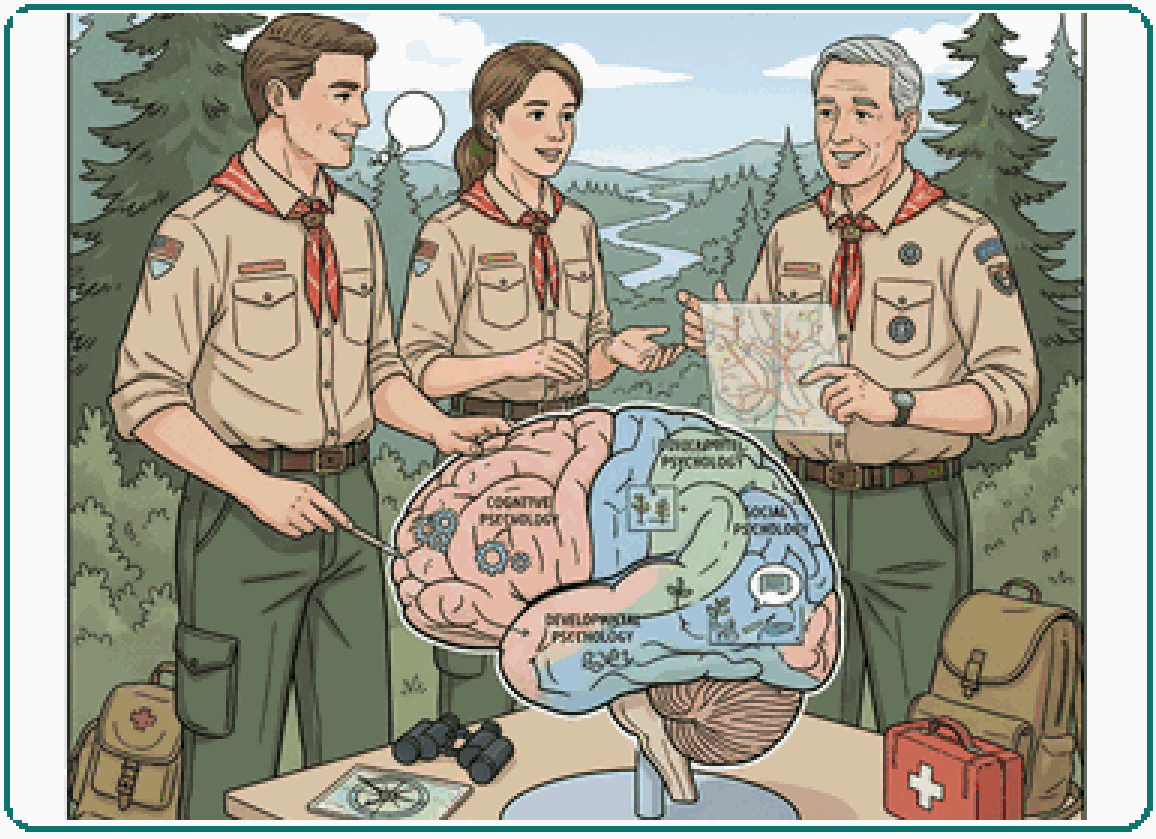
SCOUTS BSA TEST LAB SERIES

PSYCHOLOGY



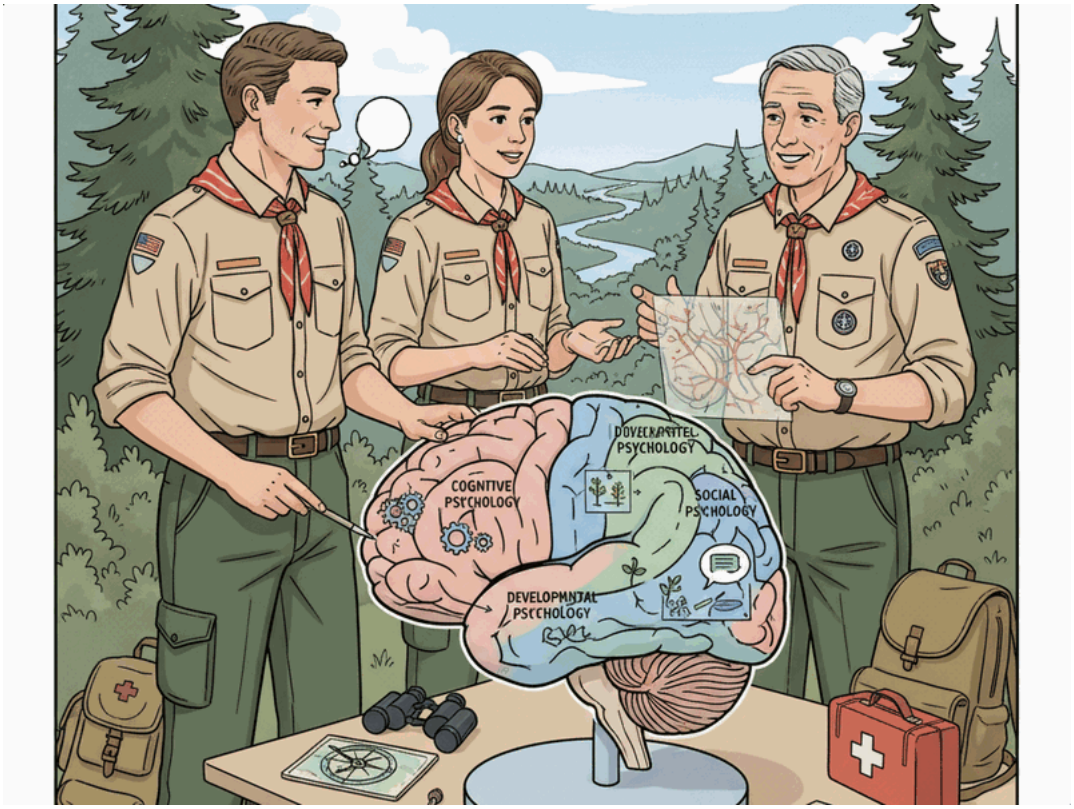
Scouting America

Scouting America Merit Badge Reference Guide: Psychology
Req 1: Foundations of Psychology & Pioneers of the Field

Do the following: (a) Define psychology in your own words and explain its impact on daily life. (b) Identify two famous psychologists and describe their contributions to the field.

Key Pamphlet Study Points:

- Psychology Sub-Req 1a: Define psychology in your own words and explain its impact on daily life.
- Psychology Sub-Req 1b: Identify two famous psychologists and describe their contributions to the field.
- Core Standard 1 (Req 1): (a) Define psychology in your own words and explain its impact on daily life.
- Core Standard 2 (Req 1): (b) Identify two famous psychologists and describe their contributions to the field.



Scouting America Merit Badge Reference Guide: Psychology
Req 2: Applying Psychological Principles in Leadership Skits

Do the following: (a) Write a script for a short (1?2 minute) skit that demonstrates how a leader might apply the study of psychology to better lead a group. Share your script with your counselor. (b) With the help of others, rehearse and perform your skit for your counselor (in-person or by recorded video). Explain to your counselor the plot and discuss the connections between psychology and leadership that are shown in your skit.

Key Pamphlet Study Points:
- Psychology Sub-Req 2a: Write a script for a short (1-2 minute) skit that demonstrates how a leader might apply the study of psychology to better lead a group.
- Psychology Sub-Req 2b: With the help of others, rehearse and perform your skit for your counselor (in-person or by recorded video).
- Core Standard 1 (Req 2): (a) Write a script for a short (1-2 minute) skit that demonstrates how a leader might apply the study of psychology to better lead a group.
- Core Standard 2 (Req 2): Share your script with your counselor.



Scouting America Merit Badge Reference Guide: Psychology
Req 3: Mental Health, Protective Factors & Youth Resilience

Do the following: (a) In your own words, define mental health. (b) Discuss with your counselor the concepts of protective factors, risk factors, and resilience for the mental health of youth close to your age in your community. Share ideas about how your community could strengthen the resilience of young people.

Key Pamphlet Study Points:
- Psychology Sub-Req 3a: In your own words, define mental health.
- Psychology Sub-Req 3b: Discuss with your counselor the concepts of protective factors, risk factors, and resilience for the mental health of youth close to your age in your community.
- Core Standard 1 (Req 3): (a) In your own words, define mental health.
- Core Standard 2 (Req 3): (b) Discuss with your counselor the concepts of protective factors, risk factors, and resilience for the mental health of youth close to your age in your.



Scouting America Merit Badge Reference Guide: Psychology
Req 4: Two-Week Daily Time Log & Screen-Time Balance

Do the following: (a) For two weeks, create a tracking log and record daily how you spend your time at school, in Scouting, and at each of your other activities with your friends, family, and others close to you. Think about how these things made you feel and draw your own emoji next to each entry to summarize your feelings from each experience. (b) Review your two-week tracking log with your counselor and discuss the trends you notice about the activities you did and the emotions you felt.

Key Pamphlet Study Points:
- Psychology Sub-Req 4a: For two weeks, create a tracking log and record daily how you spend your time at school, in Scouting, and at each of your other activities with your friends.
- Psychology Sub-Req 4b: Review your two-week tracking log with your counselor and discuss the trends you notice about the activities you did and the emotions you felt.
- Core Standard 1 (Req 4): (a) For two weeks, create a tracking log and record daily how you spend your time at school, in Scouting, and at each of your other activities with your.
- Core Standard 2 (Req 4): Think about how these things made you feel and draw your own emoji next to each entry to summarize your feelings from each experience.



Scouting America Merit Badge Reference Guide: Psychology
Req 5: Practicing Empathy & Developing Resilience in Scouting

Do the following: (a) In your own words, define empathy and give examples of how you might show empathy to others. (b) Discuss the importance of resilience and how Scouting experiences develop resilience.

Key Pamphlet Study Points:
- Psychology Sub-Req 5a: In your own words, define empathy and give examples of how you might show empathy to others.
- Psychology Sub-Req 5b: Discuss the importance of resilience and how Scouting experiences develop resilience.
- Core Standard 1 (Req 5): (a) In your own words, define empathy and give examples of how you might show empathy to others.
- Core Standard 2 (Req 5): (b) Discuss the importance of resilience and how Scouting experiences develop resilience.



Scouting America Merit Badge Reference Guide: Psychology
Req 6: Community of Hope, Scout Oath & Personal Reflection

Describe how the Scout Oath and Law help create a community of hope and support in Scouting. Write a short personal oath or law that expresses how you can create hope and support in your troop or community. Explain to your counselor why you chose those words.

Key Pamphlet Study Points:
- Core Standard 1 (Req 6): Describe how the Scout Oath and Law help create a community of hope and support in Scouting.
- Core Standard 2 (Req 6): Write a short personal oath or law that expresses how you can create hope and support in your troop or community.
- Core Standard 3 (Req 6): Explain to your counselor why you chose those words.
- Counselor Conference Readiness: Be prepared to describe your findings and personal reflections on Community of Hope, Scout Oath & Personal Reflection with your Merit Badge Counselor.



Scouting America Merit Badge Reference Guide: Psychology
Req 7: Psychology Careers, Education & Licensing Pathways

Identify three career opportunities that would use skills and knowledge in psychology. Pick one and research the training, education, certification requirements, experience, and expenses associated with entering the field. Research the prospects for employment, starting salary, advancement opportunities, and career goals related to this career. Discuss what you learned with your counselor and whether you might be interested in this career.

Key Pamphlet Study Points:
- Core Standard 1 (Req 7): Identify three career opportunities that would use skills and knowledge in psychology.
- Core Standard 2 (Req 7): Pick one and research the training, education, certification requirements, experience, and expenses associated with entering the field.
- Core Standard 3 (Req 7): Research the prospects for employment, starting salary, advancement opportunities, and career goals related to this career.
- Core Standard 4 (Req 7): Discuss what you learned with your counselor and whether you might be interested in this career.



Scouting America Merit Badge Reference Guide: Psychology
Req 8: Scouting America Test Lab Feedback & Evaluation

Complete the survey below to complete the test lab requirements

Key Pamphlet Study Points:
- Core Standard 1 (Req 8): Complete the survey below to complete the test lab requirements.
- Key Terminology & Evidence: Document specific examples, definitions, and field observations for Scouting America Test Lab Feedback & Evaluation in your Psychology Workbook.
- Safety & Policy Alignment: Follow the BSA Guide to Safe Scouting, Two-Deep Leadership, and the Buddy System during all Psychology Req 8 activities.
- Counselor Conference Readiness: Be prepared to complete your findings and personal reflections on Scouting America Test Lab Feedback & Evaluation with your Merit Badge Counselor.

